GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

January 28th, 2022
Volume 233, Issue 1016
Week 4

Highlights:

- **Bouncing back.**
- **Bangla surge.**
- **Pakistan emerges.**
- **Sluggish Turkey.**
- **Lunar holidays.**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"To know how much there is to know is the beginning of learning to live."

– *Dorothy West*

MARKET COMMENTARY

EYE OF THE TIGER!

Following a somewhat slower start to the year, vessel prices seem to be bouncing back in both Pakistan and Bangladesh this week.

Steel plate prices have improved overall (especially in India) and the lack of tonnage continues to frustrate Recyclers. As such, any available tonnage is seeing intense competition at and above market pricing from hungry end Buyers.

Meanwhile, following a sluggish few months of performance, the Bangladeshi market seems to have come roaring back to the forefront this week, with a noticeable increase in levels anywhere between USD 20 – USD 30/LDT, as the Chattogram market seems to finally wake up.

Pakistan too is not far behind the Bangladeshi market and has also improved this week – so much so that any geographically positioned tonnage is likely to end up in Gadani hands, despite the far superior levels on offer from Bangladesh.

India is similarly in a good place at present but is simply unable to compete with the rampant Bangladesh and Pakistani markets. As such, Alang Buyers are only able to secure HKC or specialist / non-ferrous units, so uncompetitive is the Indian ship recycling market on any available market vessels at present.

On the Western end, the Turkish market continues its steady but sluggish performance as the Lira stabilizes at record lows, yet the relatively stable import and local steel prices have kept vessel offerings at impressive highs.

Overall, as the Chinese New Year holidays approach, it is expected to be be a quieter period of time in terms of supply and activity. Notwithstanding, it is hoped that more Owners will take advantage of these stunning rates, as the year of the Tiger commences!

For week 4 of 2022, GMS demo rankings / pricing for the week are as below.

Demo Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	Improving	610 / LDT	620 / LDT	630 / LDT
2	Pakistan	Improving	600 / LDT	610 / LDT	620 / LDT
3	India	Improving	580 / LDT	590 / LDT	600 / LDT
4	Turkey	Steady	330 / LDT	340 / LDT	350 / LDT

All at GMS would like to wish readers a Happy Chinese / Lunar New Year!

BANGLADESH

SURGING BACK!

Steel improves.

Bangladeshi Buyers have come surging back this week, as steel plate prices improve nearly USD 18/Ton, and demand starts to pick up following a largely inert Christmas / New Year period.

As a result, Chattogram Buyers have reportedly picked up a couple of vessels already in Cash Buyer hands (and sold on an 'as is' basis some time ago), including some locally preferred large LDT units.

Above 600.

Given the way levels are persisting well above the USD 600/LDT mark, it is certainly surprising that more Owners have decided not to cash in on their older assets at these impressive levels, particularly in the beleaguered tanker sector where charter rates are still in the doldrums and showing little hope of any immediate rebound.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

FIRM BUT FAR!

Several specialist, non-ferrous units (stainless steel tankers and Russian fish factories) have made their way to Alang this year, especially as prices improve closer to the USD 600/LDT mark over the course of January.

Taking vessels.

However, Indian Buyers are still unable to compete on competitive market tonnage, which is largely ending up in competing Pakistani or Bangladeshi hands. Even previously favoured passenger units are reportedly finding their way onto Pakistani shores.

On the local fundamentals front, the Indian Rupee is trading at a steady level in the high Rs. 74s against the U.S. Dollar, whilst local steel plate prices have improved by nearly USD 16/Ton over the course of the week, leaving the Indian market positively poised as we enter into February.

Positively poised.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

Coming up!

Raising game.

Having missed out on a number of market and even geographically positioned units, Gadani Buyers knew they had to raise the level of their game if they were to secure their share of any of the dwindling number of market / private vessels.

The holiday season in the East is now upon us and this is likely to lead to an even greater dearth in the availability of units for hungry Recyclers.

Market dynamics.

It will therefore be interesting to see how market dynamics resume post holidays, given that many end Buyers have plots cleared and are ready to buy and compete aggressively on any available units.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

LETHARGY?

The Turkish market seems to be going through a lethargic phase with virtually no news being reported on the SNP front. While reports of a trickle of tonnage arriving the waterfront do make it from time to time, there is little market tonnage to negotiate at present.

Market SNP.

Fundamentals too remain relatively stable as both import & local steel plate prices remain steady and the Turkish Lira buoys around the mid TRY 13s against the U.S. Dollar.

As reported last year, most local Buyers are eager to get tonnage basis late Q1 delivery and as such, we can only hope this market stays steady (or even firms further) when the time comes.

Q1 improvement.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

AMAZING FACTS

- *The wedding of Princess Diana and Prince Charles was watched by 750 million people worldwide in 1981; sadly, 2.5 billion watched her funeral in 1997.*
- *With 3.572 billion viewers, half the world's population watched the 2018 FIFA World Cup of soccer (or football, as many international fans call it), which is held every four years. That number is on par with the 2016 Summer Olympics; but only a quarter of the world watched the less-popular Winter Olympics in 2018.*
- *There are no muscles in your fingers: Their function is controlled by muscles in your palms and arms.*
- *The hardest working muscle in your body is your heart: It pumps more than 2,000 gallons of blood a day and beats more than 2.5 billion times in a 70-year life span.*
- *It's impossible to hum while holding your nose.*
- *Skin is the body's largest organ.*
- *The earth's circumference is 24,900 miles.*
- *All of an adult human's blood vessels, if laid out end to end, would be about 100,000 miles, so they could encircle the earth four times.*
- *According to recent research, the human nose can distinguish at least a trillion different odors.*
- *The longest fingernails ever were over 28 feet in total. American Lee Redmond started growing them in 1979 and set the record in 2008. Sadly, she lost her nails in a car crash in 2009.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**BEACHING TIDES**
February 05 – Vasant Panchami.	January 29 – February 06 February 15 – February 22 February 28 – March 06

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**BEACHING TIDES**
February 21 – Shaheed Day	February 01 – February 04 February 18 – February 21

IMPORTANT BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
February 01 – 04 – Spring Festival	February 05 – Kashmir Solidarity Day	**No holidays in February.**

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ALANG - Port Position as of January 28, 2022

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Bratya Stoyanovy	3,484	Fishing	Arrived December 24
2	*Coral*	*2,763*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Beached January 25*
3	Glier	1,806	Chemical Tanker	Arrived January 28
4	**Harriet**	**2,292**	**Tanker**	**Arrived December 09**
5	Installer	5,525	Supply Vessel	Arrived January 28
6	Prosperity	5,314	Chemical Tanker	Arrived January 25
7	Saehan Chemstar	2,518	Chemical Tanker	Arrived January 24
8	*Sea Golden*	*2,830*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Beached January 25*
9	*Yeti*	*4,603*	*Oil Tanker*	*Beached January 23*
Total Tonnage		**31,134**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of January 28, 2022

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Bumble Bee 3 (Under Tow)	711	Hopper Barge	Arrived January 26
2	C Fortune	5,744	Tanker	Arrived January 27
3	Indoia	9,420	Tanker	Arrived January 22
4	*Itfa 3*	*1,278*	*Reefer*	*Beached January 22*
5	*Nigata*	*2,085*	*Tanker*	*Beached January 25*
6	*Ocean 68*	*2,369*	*General Cargo*	*Beached January 24*
7	Ocean Mighty	435	Tug	Arrived January 26
8	Ravi	2,084	Tug	Arrived January 25
9	Rich Sino	7,301	Tanker	Beached January 21
10	Y6	8,243	Bulk Carrier	Arrived January 24
Total Tonnage		**39,669**		

GADANI - Port Position as of January 28, 2022

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	**Atlantic Enterprise**	**4,083.00**	**Accomodation Ship**	**Arrived December 07**
3	*Louisa*	*7,798.00*	*Tanker*	*Beached January 25*
2	Oriental Dragon	10,300.00	Passenger Vessel	Arrived January 25
Total Tonnage		**22,181**		

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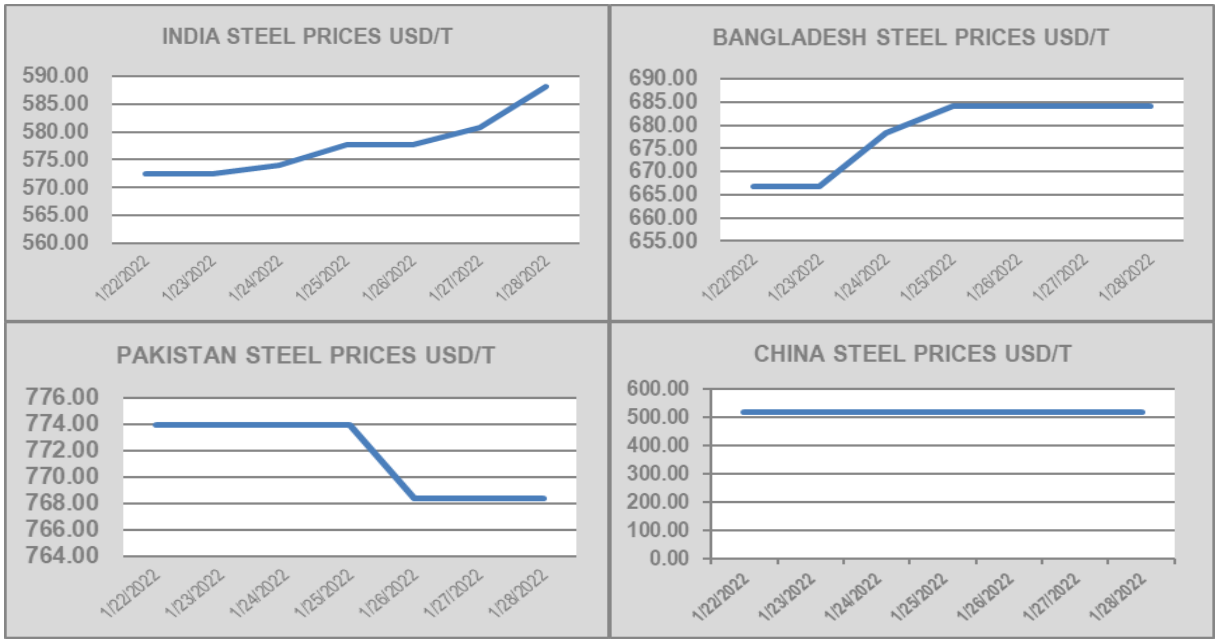
Steel Plate Prices

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
1/22/2022	572.43	42,600.00	773.98	138,000.00	666.67	57,000.00	519.03
1/23/2022	572.43	42,600.00	773.98	138,000.00	666.67	57,000.00	519.03
1/24/2022	574.03	42,800.00	773.98	138,000.00	678.36	58,000.00	519.03
1/25/2022	577.69	43,200.00	773.98	138,000.00	684.21	58,500.00	519.03
1/26/2022	577.69	43,200.00	768.37	137,000.00	684.21	58,500.00	519.03
1/27/2022	580.79	43,600.00	768.37	137,000.00	684.21	58,500.00	519.03
1/28/2022	588.16	44,100.00	768.37	137,000.00	684.21	58,500.00	519.03



www.gmsinc.net
GMS_Leadership
GMS, Inc.
snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311